

derek_washington

DEREK WASHINGTON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Eight years in digital advertising with a specialization in enterprise search. Currently managing a \$60M retail portfolio at Google's agency partner DentsuX. Deep hands-on expertise in SA360 campaign architecture, automated bidding, and cross-channel attribution. Track record of growing accounts through consultative engagement with VP- and C-level clients.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GROUP DIRECTOR, PAID SEARCH — DentsuX | Chicago, IL

January 2022 – Present

- Oversee SA360 strategy for a portfolio of 4 large-scale retail clients; total managed spend \$60M/year
- Lead client-facing QBRs, annual planning sessions, and ad hoc executive presentations
- Championed adoption of SA360 Smart Bidding across all accounts; average ROAS improved 23%
- Built internal training curriculum for SA360 onboarding; trained 12 junior and mid-level team members
- Managed direct relationships with Google LCS team and negotiated co-investment opportunities

SENIOR PAID SEARCH MANAGER — Merkle | Chicago, IL

May 2018 – January 2022

Managed search campaigns for Home Depot, JCPenney, and Macy's; portfolio spend ~\$30M
Drove SA360 implementation projects for two accounts transitioning from Google Ads direct
Developed custom bidding scripts and automated alert systems
Recognized as "top performer" in 2019 and 2020 annual reviews

PAID SEARCH ANALYST — DigitasLBi | Chicago, IL
July 2016 – May 2018

Executed day-to-day campaign management across Google Ads and Bing Ads
Assisted senior managers with SA360 reporting and optimization

EDUCATION

MBA, Marketing Concentration — DePaul University Kellstadt Graduate School of Business | 2019
B.A. Communications — Northwestern University | 2016

CERTIFICATIONS & TOOLS

Certifications: Google Ads Search, SA360, DV360, YouTube Ads, Google Analytics 4
Platforms: SA360, DV360, Google Ads, Amazon DSP, The Trade Desk, Tableau, Salesforce
Technical: SQL, Google Apps Script, Looker Studio, BigQuery (working knowledge)